

Antenatal Assessment in third trimester

Third Trimester

- Third trimester is the last phase of pregnancy.
- It lasts from weeks 29 to 40, or month 7, 8, and 9.
- During this trimester, the baby grows, develops and start to change position to get ready for birth

Antenatal Assessment

- Help monitors fetal growth and maternal well being

• Abdominal Palpation

- Abdominal palpation is a clinical examination performed during antenatal visits to assess fetal growth, position, presentation and well being.

- ~~Abdominal examination is an important part of antenatal care.~~

- It helps to monitor fetal growth and detect problems early

- Usually done in the 3rd trimester (37 weeks)

• Before examination

- Explain the procedure to the women
- Take informed consent
- Ask her to empty the bladder
- Position her in a semi-recumbent position

- Ensure privacy and comfort
- Wash hands and keep them warm.

• Inspection (looking)

- Observe size and shape of abdomen
- look for stretch marks
- check for previous surgical scars (Eg- Caesarean)
- observe fetal movements if visible.

• Palpation (feeling)

- Feel the abdomen gently with hands.
- Assess uterine size.
- Estimate fetal growth
- Determine fetal lie, position and presentation.
- Compare uterine size with landmarks like the navel.

• Fetal Assessment

Methods of fetal Assessment

- ① Clinical assessment
- ② Ultrasound examination
- ③ Biochemical tests
- ④ Biophysical techniques
- ⑤ Prenatal risk scoring

Fetal movement assessment

- Fetal movement counting is advised to all pregnant women in the last trimester.
- Reduced movements may indicate fetal distress

Ultrasound in 3rd trimester

- Ultrasound is done using abdominal probe.
- Usually performed betⁿ 34-36 weeks of pregnancy
- Assess - Growth of the fetus
 - Position of the fetus
 - Placenta and amniotic fluid.

Growth and development of fetus.

- By this stage - All vitals organs are fully developed.
- Average foetal measurements:-
Weight - 2400-2600 grams
Length - 44-46 cm.

physical features of fetus.

- Head is bigger compared to the body
- Fetus looks similar to newborn baby
- Most fetuses turn head down.

• Auscultate Fetal Heart Rate - Doppler and Pinard's Stethoscope

Auscultation - means listening to the fetal heart rate (FHR) during pregnancy and labor

It helps assess the well being of the fetus

Purpose :-

- Detects changes in the normal heart rate pattern
- Helps identify fetal distress early
- To treat the underlying problems.

- Normal fetal heart rate
 - Normal range - 110-160 beats per min.
 - Heart rate should be counted for a full 1 min.
- Pinard's stethoscope
 - It is placed in right angles to the mother's abdomen
 - It is pressed gently but firmly to hear fetal heart sound
 - Mother's pulse must be checked simultaneously to avoid confusing it with fetal heart sound.
 - Ensure that the sound heard is fetal, not maternal pulse.
- Doppler transducer
 - A Doppler device is pressed against the abdomen
 - It uses sound waves to detect and amplify the fetal heartbeat

Monitoring Uterine Contractions

- Uterine contractions may be monitored using an intrauterine pressure catheter (IUPC)
- Catheter is inserted through the vagina into the uterus.
- Helps measure strength and frequency of contractions.



